

RAJATH GOWDA

Senior Software Development Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Software Development Engineer with nearly a decade of experience in application development, test automation, performance engineering, and recent experience building AI-powered solutions. Proven ability to design reliable software, improve release quality, and lead technical executions in Agile environments. Worked across automation frameworks, observability systems, and agentic AI applications, and led cross-functional teams to build data platforms that solved real business problems and cut manual effort. Combined strong development skills with deep quality engineering expertise, and was consistently recognized across every role for improving system reliability, cost, and delivery speed.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Languages:** Java, JavaScript, Kotlin, SQL/PLSQL, Shell, Python, TypeScript
- **Backend and Frameworks:** Java, SpringBoot, Microservices, REST API, Design Patterns, Multithreading, Hibernate
- **AI and Agentic Engineering:** LLMs, RAG, Prompt Engineering, MCPs, AI-Assisted Testing, GitHub Copilot
- **Database:** Oracle, PostgreSQL, MySQL, MS SQL, Snowflake, MongoDB, Vertica, DB2
- **Cloud and DevOps:** AWS (S3, EC2, Lambda, Secrets Manager), Docker, Kubernetes, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, Maven, Gradle, JFrog
- **Test Automation:** JUnit, Selenium, Cucumber (BDD/Gherkin), REST Assured, Postman, Newman
- **Performance & Observability:** Grafana, Prometheus, OpenTelemetry, Loki, OpenObserve, AWS Cloudwatch, JMeter, Ycrash, Datadog

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Development Engineer, Pentaho, Hitachi Vantara Ltd.

Sept 2020 to Present

Bengaluru, India

- Designed and built custom, AI-powered data identification tools for enterprise customers that automatically tagged sensitive customer data with PII classifications, using LLMs integrated with the Pentaho Data Catalog (PDC) product to achieve ~80% detection accuracy relative to PDC's standard, non-LLM approach.
- Led cross-functional engineering team to design and build custom software solutions for Pentaho customers.
- Architected and maintained end-to-end test automation frameworks, automating REST API testing with REST Assured and Postman and authoring BDD suites with Selenium and Cucumber for GUI automation, to maximize coverage and minimize regression risk.
- Built an observability stack with Grafana, Prometheus, OpenObserve, Loki, and OpenTelemetry to monitor live application data, logs, metrics, and system performance, enabling proactive issue detection and resolution.
- Operated within the Production Engineering team to triage and resolve customer-reported issues on a sprint basis in an Agile environment.

IT Technical Leader, Decathlon Sports India

July 2019 to Sept 2020

Bengaluru, India

- Implemented a data archival solution (Shell, PL/SQL) that cut **AWS server costs by ~50%** while improving system performance and resolving longstanding data issues.
- Led the technical team through an organization-wide upgrade of Openbravo billing software and PostgreSQL across all India POS systems, and rolled out new features and improved stability.
- Built a wireless card payment integration for the billing system (see Key Project below) that continued to power transactions across all Decathlon stores in India.
- Migrated the code repository from Mercurial to GitHub and strengthened security and release management.
- Resolved real-time production incidents while maintaining code quality and customer support standards.

- Developed web applications using Java, JSP, PL/SQL, JavaScript, HTML, and CSS to visualize various database statistics to client users.
- Designed and built custom client applications using Java, JavaScript, and PL/SQL based on business requirements.
- Enhanced the internal ETL tool with new features, defect fixes, and UI improvements that boosted overall performance.
- Developed scheduled jobs (cron) for various business needs, reducing manual effort and improving efficiency.
- Authored JUnit tests and automation scripts for unit testing.

KEY PROJECTS

Data Migration Platform, Pentaho (PDC)

- Led a team of 4 to 6 engineers to design and build **DataPipes**, a Java based platform that migrated data between heterogeneous source and target systems using Pentaho Data Integration (PDI) and Pentaho Data Catalog (PDC).
- Designed and developed custom Java modules, packaged as **executable JAR files**, that extended PDI and PDC with masking and encryption functions to protect sensitive data during cross-system transfers.
- Architected a modular pipeline design that supported multiple source and target data types without requiring pipeline-specific rework, and owned technical decisions, code reviews, and delivery timelines across the project lifecycle.

Wireless Card Payment Integration, Decathlon Sports India

- Designed and built **Spring Boot based REST APIs** to integrate Decathlon's billing software with the wireless card payment terminal (Java, JavaScript, PL/SQL).
- This integration continued to power card transactions across all Decathlon stores in India.

LLM-Powered PII Detection and Classification Engine, Pentaho (PDC)

- Architected an **LLM-based PII detection system** layered on Pentaho Data Catalog (PDC) and improved PII detection accuracy by **~80%** over PDC's native, non-LLM classifier, using RAG-based retrieval pipelines and prompt engineering.

Test Automation Suite, Pentaho (PDC and PDI)

- Built an API automation suite (Postman, Newman CLI) that covered **hundreds of test cases** across PDC's core features, applying pairwise test case design to maximize coverage while minimizing test count and maintenance overhead.
- Cut a **2-day manual regression cycle to ~2 hours** of automated execution and achieved 100% regression coverage on every release.
- Built smoke test GUI automation using the **Robocorp framework** for PDC and designed BDD-based UI test suites (Selenium, Cucumber) for the PDI web application, covering key user workflows end to end.

Performance Engineering and Observability, Pentaho (PDC and PDI)

- Built an **observability stack** (Grafana, Prometheus, OpenObserve, Loki, OpenTelemetry) across both products for real-time metrics, logs, and performance monitoring.
- Used the stack to identify multiple **java performance bottlenecks and memory leak scenarios** and drove improvements to the application's caching mechanism as a result.

EDUCATION

B.E., Electronics and Communications Engineering

Aug 2012 to June 2016*New Horizon College of Engineering, Bengaluru*

ACHIEVEMENTS

- Received the "Pat on the Back" Award at Tech Mahindra Ltd. (Dec 2017 and Dec 2018)
- Received a "Certificate of Appreciation" from Decathlon Sports India. (Jun 2020)
- Received recognition at Hitachi Vantara by leadership for identifying critical performance issues and driving improvements that enhanced system reliability. (Dec 2025)